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W E D N E S D A Y , A P R I L 1 5 , 2 0 2 6

Healey calls for curbs on social media to shield kids

Sites would have to limit under-18 to 2 hours a day

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey on Tuesday added to a sudden surge on Beacon Hill to rein in technology's influence on children and teens, unveiling a proposal to restrict the amount of time minors can spend on social media platforms that she and other officials assailed as exploitative and addictive.

Her legislation would require those platforms to implement a host of limits on minors, including restricting which features children have access to on the sites.

State officials point to years of research from medical experts that found excessive social media use among young people can contribute to heightened mental health issues and declining performance in school.

"Social media is driving a tremendous amount of anxiety and hurting kids in a number of different ways," Healey said at a State House news conference. "These companies have designed products to be addictive and to exploit young people's insecurities."

Representatives for Meta, the owner of Facebook and Instagram, Google, and TikTok did not immediately return requests for comment.

The proposal comes at a time of mounting tensions over the power, reach, and influence of social media platforms in daily life. In just the past few weeks, the corporate owners of Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube have lost

HEALEY, Page A6

Spending soars for Mass. congressional candidates

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

The price of winning a seat in Congress keeps rising. Massachusetts' only open House race this year could test just how high the tab can go.

Democratic candidates in the Sixth Congressional District are collecting, or giving themselves, cash at a pace that would have been unthinkable not long ago. Some appear poised to blow past the roughly \$2.5 million that winners in similar open congressional contests spent just a few cycles back, a trend driven by the escalating pressure to raise more money, higher campaign limits on what candidates can collect, and an ever-growing number of ways to actually spend it.

"[The cost] is only going up," said Sean Curran, a veteran Democratic fund-raiser and founder of Waterville Consulting in Boston.

Nationally, congressional campaign spending has more than tripled over the last 25 years, climbing from a combined \$3 billion in 2000 to an \$11 billion peak in 2020, according to data from Open Secrets. The total cost of congressional races in 2024 hit \$9.5 billion, and in Massachusetts — where incumbents

CONGRESS, Page A4

What it takes to win a congressional seat

The cost in Massachusetts continues to rise. Dan Koh, the top fund-raiser in the 2026 Sixth District race, has already surpassed the amount raised by the winners in 2018 and 2020 races for open seats, as well his own fund-raising haul from eight years ago.

2026 SIXTH DISTRICT

Dan Koh	\$3,500,000
John Beccia	\$2,400,000
Tram Nguyen	\$430,000

2020 FOURTH DISTRICT

Jake Auchincloss (W)	\$2,873,219
Ihssane Leckey	\$2,159,988
Alan Khazei	\$1,915,856

2018 THIRD DISTRICT

Dan Koh	\$3,207,855
Lori Trahan (W)	\$2,642,929
Rufus Gifford	\$2,345,005

SOURCE: Federal Election Commission records. (W) denotes winner in 2018 and 2020 races. 2026 figures represent totals raised to date, per campaigns. JOHN HANCOCK/GLOBE STAFF

"There's been talk of cutting certain departments and potentially laying off certain staff members. It was more just a matter of when, rather than if."

RAE SALVATORIELLO, a second-year student



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Another small college forced to close its doors

Hampshire's financial woes insurmountable

By Brooke Hauser
and Diti Kohli

GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — Hampshire College is closing after nearly six decades of offering an unconventional liberal arts education that expanded and deepened the academic ecosystem of the Five College area and ingrained its way deep into the fabric of the Pioneer Valley.

Beset by poor finances for years, the Amherst school tried

to bolster operations with a fund-raising campaign, recruitment of additional students, and other innovative measures. Those proved either too short-lived or failed to materialize in time to save the college.

Existing students can now take classes through the fall semester, but newly admitted students will not be allowed to enroll and instead will receive refunds. Hampshire plans to hold its final commencement ceremonies in May and December.

"Despite this herculean effort, the financial pressures on the College's operations have become increasingly complex, compounded by shifting exter-

nal factors," president Jennifer Chrisler wrote in an email to the Hampshire community. "We are faced with the clear, heartbreaking reality that progress . . . has fallen far short of what we had hoped."

Located on approximately 800 acres in Amherst, Hampshire is the smallest and quirkiest institution in the Five College Consortium, which includes the University of Massachusetts, as well as Amherst, Mount Holyoke, and Smith colleges. The school's unconventional model broke away from traditional majors and mandated instead that each stu-

HAMPSHIRE, Page A7

NECK BRACED



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Spring really feels like it's here at last, and it's time for the Swan Boats, as workers Jack Paget (left) and Dan Paget put together the famed tourist attraction this week at the Public Garden.

Cutting them to the bone

Some hair stylists find that listening to clients' traumas can be just too much

BETH TEITELL

COMMENTARY

When I first heard about the hairstylist's pin, it sounded light, jokey. "Please no trauma dumping," it read.

But in fact, it was a cry for help — the only way Lucy Ankner could think of to gently remind the people in her chair that she's trained as a hairdresser, not a mental health professional.

"I want to be supportive," said Ankner, who cuts hair at Lucy Danger Hair, in Belmont, "but not only do I not know how to respond to clients, I don't know how to process it myself."

In two years, the pin has had almost no effect. And Ankner has heard so much heaviness — about a

stepfather who sexually abused her client, a dad who intentionally killed a childhood pet — that many days after work, she pulls into her driveway and just sits there.

"I stare into the abyss," she said.

In pop culture, stylists are confessors, therapists — the friend who takes your side against the world, no matter your role in the conflict. Indeed, the pin's creator, Shannon Donahue, of Somerville, said that when she first put it on her Etsy store's Instagram, it sparked such

HAIRSTYLISTS, Page A6

New guard shakes up Quincy political scene

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

QUINCY — Politics as usual has been upended inside the thick granite walls of historic City Hall. There, seven-term Mayor Thomas Koch apparently can no longer count on the lopsided support that has characterized much of his 18-year run.

The nine-member City Council is now debating issues, which hadn't been the norm. Lockstep votes are no longer routine, a sharp break from 2024 when councilors voted unanimously 156 of 157 times.

And residents are using a revived forum for public comment by making themselves heard —

often with insults. For some, the messy show of civics is a huge relief as well as a long-overdue re-balancing of power.

It's a change that followed the stunning defeat in November of five councilors aligned with Koch, a reversal that could threaten the mayor's clout in the city, which has undergone a rapid, vibrant makeover.

The political changes also have ignited a firestorm, one that has pitted many longtime Quincy residents, who are primarily white, against newer politicians in this historically blue-collar city of 101,000 residents, nearly one-third of whom are

QUINCY, Page A7

President Trump's attacks on Pope Leo XIV are causing fresh headaches for Republicans, who are counting on the votes of Catholics in this year's midterms. **A2.**

A man was charged with stealing valuables in the burglary of a sea-side Beverly mansion. **B1.**

thawing snow pile has left behind something unexpected: a four-door hatchback. And it's not alone. **B1.**

their first direct talks in decades, meeting in Washington to try to end a bloody conflict that has been threatening to derail the broader cease-fire. **A3.**

At a vacant lot in Somerville, a

Israeli and Lebanese officials held

Bolt faced

Wednesday: Thunderstorms. High 70-75. Low 53-58.

Thursday: Another warm one. High 68-73. Low 56-61.

Sunrise: 6:03 Sunset: 7:26

Weather and Comics, G6-7.



Winning the race for the restaurants

Whether you're running or watching, check out these places close to the Marathon course where you can fuel up. **G1.**

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